

أَعُوذُ بِاللَّهِ مِنَ الشَّيْطَانِ الرَّجِيمِ
بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

Lisan ul Quran — Lecture 27 and 28

The Murakkab Jarri • the Huroof ul Jarrah

1. The Harf and its kinds

In Arabic grammar the *Harf* is one of the three categories of the *Kalimah*. A *Harf* is a meaningful word, yet for its meaning and for the sense to become clear it must be joined to a noun or a verb. The *huroof* join themselves to nouns and verbs and establish a connection.

An important point: All *huroof* are *Mabni*, that is, their form and vowel never change.

Kind	Definition
Huroof Ghayr 'Amilah	If these come before a noun or a verb they bring about no change in its I'raab
Huroof 'Amilah	These bring about a change in the I'raab of a noun or a verb

The *Huroof ul Jarrah* are in fact among the *Huroof 'Amilah*, since they carry the noun that follows them into the state of *jarr*.

2. The two causes of a noun being Majroor

- The first: its being a *Mudaf Ilayh*.
- The second: one of the *Huroof ul Jarrah* coming before it.

The definition of the Murakkab Jarri: In Arabic there are certain *huroof* that carry a noun into the state of *jarr*; these are called the *Huroof ul Jarrah*. And a noun in the state of *jarr* is called *Majroor*. The *jarr* and the *majroor* together form a *Murakkab Jarri*.

Worth remembering: The *Murakkab Jarri* too is a *Murakkab Naqis*. It does not by itself form a sentence but becomes one element of a sentence. Saying "in the book" does not complete the sense.

3. The number of the Huroof ul Jarrah

In Arabic the *Huroof ul Jarrah* are **seventeen**, but of these the ones used most often in the Qur'an are **eleven**. It is these eleven that this lesson takes up in detail.

The eleven that occur abundantly in the Qur'an

بِ	تَ	وَ	كَ
لِ	فِي	عَنْ	مِنْ
إِلَى	عَلَى	حَتَّى	

The complete list of seventeen

Besides the eleven above, the remaining six are given below. These either occur very rarely in the Qur'an or do not occur at all.

Harf	Meaning	Explanation
رَبَّ	many a, sometimes	it enters only upon a Nakirah noun
مُدَّ	since	used for time
مُنْذُ	since	also for time, and it is the original of مُدَّ
خَلَا	except	used for exception
عَدَا	except	used for exception
حَاشَا	except	used for exception

A difference in counting: Some scholars of *Nahw* add لَعَلَّ, كَيْ and مَتَى to these and bring the number up to twenty. The difference is only one of counting, not of principle.

4. The difference between the Huroof ul Jarrah and the Huroof ul Hijaa'

The first five *Huroof ul Jarrah* — لِ، كَ، وَ، تَ، بِ — look just like letters of the *Huroof ul Hijaa'*. It is therefore necessary to grasp the difference between the two.

Huroof ul Hijaa'	Huroof ul Jarrah
they have no meaning of their own	they carry some meaning of their own

Huroof ul Hijaa'	Huroof ul Jarrah
any vowel at all may come upon them	their vowel is fixed and settled
they serve to build words	they are themselves meaningful words
they may come at the beginning, middle or end of a word	they always come before a noun

5. The Huroof ul Jarrah in detail

5.1 The Harf ul Jarr Bi

The *Harf ul Jarr* بِ always comes with a kasrah. It is used in the sense of "with", and besides that in the senses of "by", "in" and "of".

In Arabic بِ is also used for an oath. The context makes clear where it gives the sense of an oath and where the sense of "with".

وَقَالُوا بِعِزَّةِ فِرْعَوْنَ إِنَّا لَنَحْنُ الْغَالِبُونَ

(Surah ash-Shu'ara: 44)

Translation: And the magicians said: by the might of Pharaoh, indeed it is we who will be the victors.

A third case: Where بِ gives neither of these two senses, it is being used **as a silah** with some verb — that is, the verb is made transitive by means of this very particle.

An analysis of Bismika

When a *dameer* joins a noun it is called a *Dameer Majroor*, and the construction becomes a *Murakkab Idafi*, as in اِسْمُكَ, "your name". If the *Harf ul Jarr* بِ is placed at its beginning, the *Mudaf* becomes *Majroor* and turns into اِسْمِكَ, giving the complete construction بِاِسْمِكَ.

Here the hamzah of اِسْمِ is a *Hamzat ul Wasl*, which falls away when read joined. This whole structure is an example of a *Murakkab Jarri*, meaning "with your name".

بِاِسْمِكَ اللَّهُمَّ أَمُوتْ وَأَحْيَا

(the du'a for sleeping — O Allah, with Your name I die and I live)

Bismillah

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ is a *Murakkab Jarri* in which بِ is the *Harf ul Jarr* and a whole *Murakkab Idafi* comes in the place of the *majroor*.

Something unique: بِسْمِ is the single word in which the *Hamzat ul Wasl* is not even written. In every other place the hamzah is written and merely not pronounced.

Further examples of Bi

Murakkab Jarri	Translation
بِالْحَقِّ	with the truth
بِالْقَلَمِ	by the pen

Murakkab Jarri	Translation
بِنَصْرِ اللَّهِ	with the help of Allah
بِإِذْنِ اللَّهِ	by the leave of Allah
يُكَذِّبُ بِالذِّينِ	he denies the Day of Recompense
أَمَنْتُ بِاللَّهِ	I have believed in Allah

الَّذِي عَلَّمَ بِالْقَلَمِ

(Surah al-'Alaq: 4)

Translation: Who taught by the pen.

5.2 The Harf ul Jarr Ta

This is used only for an oath, and it is **particular to the name of Allah**. No other noun comes after it.

تَاللَّهِ

(by Allah)

5.3 The Waw of oath

The waw of oath is general. It is used with the name of Allah, and Allah has also used it with other nouns.

How to recognise it: If the noun coming after the waw carries a kasrah, it gives the sense of an oath. It comes before a noun and carries that noun into the state of *jarr*.

- وَالْعَصْرِ — by time
- وَالشَّمْسِ — by the sun
- وَالتِّينِ وَالزَّيْتُونِ — by the fig and the olive

In the Qur'an this is the particle used most often for an oath.

The difference between the Waw of 'Atf and the Waw of oath

Waw ul 'Atf	Waw of oath
it comes between two nouns, two verbs or two particles	it comes only before nouns
it does not come at the beginning of speech	it always comes at the beginning of speech
it does not make the noun Majroor	it makes the noun Majroor

5.4 The Harf ul Jarr Ka

This is used for *tashbeeh*, that is, for likeness. It is rendered "like", "as" and "resembling".

Construction	Its parsing
كَالْحِجَارَةِ	كَ the Harf ul Jarr, الْحِجَارَةِ the majroor
كَعَصْفٍ مَّاكُولٍ	كَ the Harf ul Jarr, عَصْفٍ the majroor, and مَّاكُولٍ its Sifah
كَالْفَرَاشِ الْمَبْتُوثِ	كَ the Harf ul Jarr, الْفَرَاشِ the majroor, and الْمَبْتُوثِ its Sifah
كَالْأَنْعَامِ	كَ the Harf ul Jarr, الْأَنْعَامِ the majroor

Look at the second and third examples: in them a *Murakkab Tawsifi* has come in the place of the *majroor*, and the *Sifah* has become *Majroor* as well.

5.5 The Lam ul Jarrah

A lam after which a noun goes into the state of *jarr* is called the *Lam ul Jarrah*. It is rendered "for".

- لِي + الْمُتَّقُونَ = لِلْمُتَّقِينَ — for those mindful of Allah
- لِي + الْكَافِرُونَ = لِلْكَافِرِينَ — for the disbelievers
- الْحَمْدُ لِلَّهِ — all praise is for Allah

The Lam ut Tamleek

The *Lam ul Jarrah* is also used for ownership, and in that case it is called the *Lam ut Tamleek*.

- إِنَّا لِلَّهِ — indeed we belong to Allah
- لِلَّهِ مَا فِي السَّمُوتِ وَالْأَرْضِ — to Allah belongs whatever is in the heavens and the earth

The vowel of the Lam ul Jarrah

With what	Vowel	Examples
with a noun	kasrah	لِرَبِّدِ ، لِلَّهِ ، لِلْمُتَّقِينَ
with the dama'ir	fathah	لَهُمْ ، لَكُمْ ، لَهُنَّ
with the Yaa' ul Mutakallim	kasrah	لِي

About Lee: With the *Yaa' ul Mutakallim* the *Lam ul Jarrah* comes with a kasrah, and the *Yaa' ul Mutakallim* may carry either a sukoon or a fathah — both are sound.

The difference between the Lam ul Jarrah and the Lam ut Ta'reef

Lam ut Ta'reef	Lam ul Jarrah
it comes with a sukoon	it comes with a kasrah
it makes a noun Ma'rifah	it may enter both a Ma'rifah and a Nakirah noun
it does not change the l'raab	it changes the l'raab
it has no meaning of its own	it has a meaning of its own

A particular rule: When the *Lam ul Jarrah* enters a *Mu'arraaf bil Lam* noun, the Hamzat ul Wasl of al- is not even written, as in لِلْمُتَّقِينَ ، لِلْكَافِرِينَ ، لِلْمُسْلِمِ.

5.6 The Harf ul Jarr Fee

It is rendered "in".

فِي الْأَرْضِ ، فِي السَّمَاءِ ، فِي لَيْلَةِ الْقَدْرِ ، فِي الْقُرْآنِ

An important example: فِي الْقُرْآنِ وَالْحَدِيثِ. Here both words are *Majroor* on account of the *Harf ul Jarr* فِي, and the *Waw ul 'Atf* has joined the two together.

Rule: The two nouns coming before and after the *Waw ul 'Atf* have one and the same state of I'raab.

Hadith

مَنْ خَرَجَ فِي طَلَبِ الْعِلْمِ فَهُوَ فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ حَتَّى يَرْجِعَ

Translation: Whoever goes out in the seeking of knowledge is in the way of Allah until he returns.

- طَلَبِ الْعِلْمِ is a *Murakkab Idafi* meaning "the seeking of knowledge". After فِي enters it becomes فِي طَلَبِ الْعِلْمِ, "in the seeking of knowledge".
- سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ is also a *Murakkab Idafi*. After فِي enters it becomes فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ, "in the way of Allah".

An important point: This hadith holds two *Murakkabat Naqisah*: a *Murakkab Jarri*, and in the place of the *majroor* a *Murakkab Idafi*. That is, one construction sits inside another. Likewise فِي لَيْلَةِ الْقَدْرِ is a *Murakkab Jarri* with a *Murakkab Idafi* in the place of the *majroor*.

5.7 The Harf ul Jarr 'An

It is rendered "from" or "about".

وَلَا تُسْأَلُ عَنْ أَصْحَابِ الْجَحِيمِ

(Surah al-Baqarah: 119)

Translation: And you will not be asked about the companions of Hellfire.

يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا لَا تُلْهِكُمْ أَمْوَالُكُمْ وَلَا أَوْلَادُكُمْ عَنْ ذِكْرِ اللَّهِ

(Surah al-Munafiqun: 9)

Translation: O you who believe, let not your wealth or your children divert you from the remembrance of Allah.

الَّذِينَ يَصُدُّونَ عَنْ سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ

(Surah al-A'raf: 45)

Translation: Those who turn people away from the way of Allah.

'An in the chain of a hadith

In Arabic, when the chain of a hadith is given, the *Harf ul Jarr* عَنْ is used abundantly to show the passing of a narration from one narrator to the next.

- عَنْ أَنَسٍ — narrated from Anas, may Allah be pleased with him
- عَنْ عَائِشَةَ — narrated from 'A'ishah, may Allah be pleased with her

Why a fathah on 'A'ishata?: Here عَائِشَةَ is indeed *Majroor*, but being a *Ghayr Munsarif* noun its state of *jarr* is shown by a fathah rather than a kasrah.

A full analysis of 'An Abee Hurayrata

The rule of Arabic is that every *kunyah* is generally a *Murakkab Idafi*. The well-known *kunyah* أَبُو هُرَيْرَةَ is the finest example of this.

Element	Details
عَنْ	the Harf ul Jarr
أَبِي	the Mudaf, and Majroor on account of the Harf ul Jarr. It is one of the Asma' Sittah, so its l'raab appears through letters: أَبُو in raf', أَبَا in nasb and أَبِي in jarr
هُرَيْرَةَ	the Mudaf Ilayh, and a Mudaf Ilayh is always Majroor. But this is a Ghayr Munsarif noun, which is why its round taa' shows a fathah rather than a kasrah

The rule of Ijtima' as-Sakinayn

The rule: When the last letter of one word is silent and the first letter of the next word is silent too, the rule is that **the first silent letter is given a kasrah to join them.**

So when a *Mu'arraf bil Lam* noun comes after عَنْ, a kasrah is placed on the noon to join it to the following letter.

- إِنَّ الصَّلَاةَ تَنْهَى عَنِ الْفَحْشَاءِ وَالْمُنْكَرِ — indeed the prayer restrains from immorality and wrongdoing
- وَيَسْأَلُونَكَ عَنِ الْيَتَامَى — and they ask you about orphans
- يَسْأَلُونَكَ عَنِ الشَّهْرِ الْحَرَامِ — they ask you about the sacred month
- يَسْأَلُونَكَ عَنِ الْأَهْلِ — they ask you about the new moons

5.8 The Harf ul Jarr Min

It is also rendered "from".

مِنْ خَوْفٍ ، مِنْ دِيَارِكُمْ ، مِنْ فَضْلِهِ ، مِنْ شَرِّ

An important exception: By the rule of *Ijtima' as-Sakinayn* the first silent letter should take a kasrah; but to join مِنْ to the following letter a **fathah** is placed on the noon. This is an exception to that rule.

مِنْ الْبَيْتِ ، مِنْ الْمَدِينَةِ ، مِنَ الْمَسْجِدِ ، مِنَ السَّمَاءِ
سُبْحَانَ الَّذِي أَسْرَى بِعَبْدِهِ لَيْلًا مِّنَ الْمَسْجِدِ الْحَرَامِ إِلَى الْمَسْجِدِ الْأَقْصَى

(Surah Bani Isra'il: 1)

Translation: Exalted is He who took His servant by night from al-Masjid al-Haram to al-Masjid al-Aqsa.

In this verse الْمَسْجِدِ الْحَرَامِ parses thus: مِّنْ is the *Harf ul Jarr*, and الْمَسْجِدِ الْحَرَامِ is a *Murakkab Tawsifi* standing as the *majroor*. That is, another *Murakkab Naqis* has come in the place of the *majroor*.

5.9 The Harf ul Jarr Ila

It is rendered "towards" and "until", and it is used for **distance**.

فَفِرُّوا إِلَى اللَّهِ ، إِلَى السَّمَاءِ ، إِلَى الْإِبِلِ
إِلَى الْجِبَالِ ، إِلَى الْمَسْجِدِ ، إِلَى الْأَرْضِ

5.10 The Harf ul Jarr 'Ala

It is rendered "upon" or "over".

عَلَى قُلُوبِهِمْ ، عَلَى سَمْعِهِمْ ، عَلَى أَبْصَارِهِمْ

عَلَى الْأَرْضِ ، عَلَى الْعَرْشِ ، عَلَى الْعَلَمِينَ

A rule shared by Ila and 'Ala: Whenever words carrying standing vowels are read joined to what follows, the standing vowels turn into plain ones. This is why إِلَى and عَلَى become إِلَى and عَلَى when joined.

خَتَمَ اللَّهُ عَلَى قُلُوبِهِمْ وَعَلَى سَمْعِهِمْ وَعَلَى أَبْصَارِهِمْ غِشَاوَةٌ

(Surah al-Baqarah: 7)

Translation: Allah has set a seal upon their hearts and upon their hearing, and over their eyes is a covering.

5.11 The Harf ul Jarr Hatta

It means "until", and it is used for time.

- حَتَّى حِينَ — for a time
- حَتَّى مَطْلَعِ الْفَجْرِ — until the break of dawn. Here حَتَّى is the *Harf ul Jarr* and a *Murakkab Idafi* has come in the place of the *majroor*.

6. Another construction in the place of the Majroor

In a *Murakkab Jarri* it is not only a single noun that comes as the *majroor*; any other *Murakkab Naqis* may come there too. This is the most useful practical point of the lesson.

Murakkab Jarri	What stands as the majroor	Translation
فِي الْأَرْضِ	a single noun	in the earth
بِسْمِ اللَّهِ	a Murakkab Idafi	with the name of Allah
فِي سَبِيلِ اللَّهِ	a Murakkab Idafi	in the way of Allah
مِّنَ الْمَسْجِدِ الْحَرَامِ	a Murakkab Tawsifi	from al-Masjid al-Haram
كَالْفَرَاشِ الْمَبْثُوثِ	a Murakkab Tawsifi	like scattered moths
بِإِذْنِ رَبِّهِمْ	a complex Murakkab Idafi	by the leave of their Lord
فِيهَا	an Ism ud Dameer	in it

One construction inside another: This is the very principle that helps most in understanding the text of the Qur'an. Inside a single *Murakkab Jarri* there may sit a *Murakkab Idafi*, a *Murakkab Tawsifi* or even a complex *Murakkab Idafi*.

7. A full analysis of Surah al-Qadr

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

إِنَّا أَنْزَلْنَاهُ فِي لَيْلَةِ الْقَدْرِ ﴿١﴾ وَمَا أَدْرَاكَ مَا لَيْلَةُ الْقَدْرِ ﴿٢﴾ لَيْلَةُ الْقَدْرِ خَيْرٌ مِّنْ أَلْفِ شَهْرٍ ﴿٣﴾ تَنَزَّلُ الْمَلَائِكَةُ وَالرُّوحُ فِيهَا ﴿٤﴾ بِإِذْنِ رَبِّهِمْ مِّنْ كُلِّ أَمْرٍ ﴿٥﴾ سَلَامٌ هِيَ حَتَّىٰ مَطْلَعِ الْفَجْرِ ﴿٦﴾

Murakkab Jarri	Harf ul Jarr	Standing of the majroor
بِسْمِ اللَّهِ	بِ	a Majroor Murakkab Idafi
فِي لَيْلَةِ الْقَدْرِ	فِي	a Majroor Murakkab Idafi
مِّنْ أَلْفِ شَهْرٍ	مِّنْ	a Majroor Murakkab Idafi
فِيهَا	فِي	a Majroor Ism ud Dameer
بِإِذْنِ رَبِّهِمْ	بِ	a Majroor complex Murakkab Idafi
مِّنْ كُلِّ أَمْرٍ	مِّنْ	a Majroor Murakkab Idafi

Murakkab Jarri	Harf ul Jarr	Standing of the majroor
حَتَّى مَطْلَعِ الْفَجْرِ	حَتَّى	a Majroor Murakkab Idafi

This short Surah holds **seven Murakkabat Jarriyyah**, and in six of them another construction stands in the place of the **majroor**. Only in **فِيهَا** does a bare pronoun occupy that place.

Summary

1. The Harf is one of the three categories of the Kalimah, and all huroof are Mabni.
2. The huroof are of two kinds: Ghayr 'Amilah, which do not change the I'raab, and 'Amilah, which do.
3. The Huroof ul Jarrah are among the Huroof 'Amilah, since they carry the noun after them into the state of jarr.
4. There are two causes of a noun being Majroor: being a Mudaf Ilayh, or having a Harf ul Jarr before it.
5. The jarr and the majroor together form a Murakkab Jarri, and this too is a Murakkab Naqis.
6. In Arabic the Huroof ul Jarrah are seventeen, but the ones used most often in the Qur'an are eleven.
7. The remaining six are: حَاشَا, رَبِّ, مُذْ, مُنْذُ, خَلَا, عَدَا.
8. The Huroof ul Hijaa' have no meaning and may take any vowel, while the Huroof ul Jarrah are meaningful and their vowel is fixed.
9. The Harf ul Jarr بِ always comes with a kasrah and gives the senses of "with", "by", "in" and "of"; it also comes for an oath.
10. بِإِسْمِكَ is a Murakkab Jarri, and بِسْمِ is the single word in which the Hamzat ul Wasl is not even written.
11. The Harf ul Jarr ت comes only for an oath and is particular to the name of Allah.
12. The waw of oath is general, and in the Qur'an it is the particle most often used for an oath.
13. The Waw ul 'Atf does not come at the beginning of speech and does not make a noun Majroor; the waw of oath is the opposite in both respects.
14. The Harf ul Jarr ك comes for tashbeeh, and is rendered "like" or "as".
15. The Lam ul Jarrah is rendered "for", and where it conveys ownership it is called the Lam ut Tamleek.
16. The Lam ul Jarrah comes with a kasrah before a noun and with a fathah before the dama'ir.
17. The Lam ut Ta'reef is silent and does not change the I'raab, while the Lam ul Jarrah carries a kasrah and does change it.
18. When the Lam ul Jarrah enters a Mu'arraaf bil Lam noun, the Hamzat ul Wasl of al- is not even written.
19. The two nouns before and after the Waw ul 'Atf carry one and the same state of I'raab.
20. By the rule of Ijtima' as-Sakinayn the first silent letter takes a kasrah to join, as in عَنِ الْفَحْشَاءِ.
21. But مِنْ is excepted from that rule; a fathah is placed on its noon to join it, as in مِنَ الْبَيْتِ.
22. Words with standing vowels turn them into plain vowels when read joined, which is why عَلَى and إِلَى become عَلَى and إِلَى.
23. In a Murakkab Jarri the place of the majroor may be filled by a single noun, by a pronoun, or by another Murakkab Naqis.
24. Surah al-Qadr contains seven Murakkabat Jarriyyah, and in six of them another construction stands as the majroor.

Exercise

1. Define the Harf and describe both of its kinds.
2. Write both causes of a noun being in the state of jarr.
3. Define the Murakkab Jarri and state which kind of Murakkab it is.
4. Write the eleven Huroof ul Jarrah that occur most often in the Qur'an.
5. Write the remaining six Huroof ul Jarrah with their meanings.
6. Write all four differences between the Huroof ul Hijaa' and the Huroof ul Jarrah.
7. Explain the three uses of the Harf ul Jarr بِ with examples.
8. Give a full analysis of بِاسْمِكَ.
9. What is unique about بِسْمِ?
10. Write all three differences between the Waw ul 'Atf and the waw of oath.
11. Write four examples with the Harf ul Jarr ك and parse each one.
12. What vowel does the Lam ul Jarrah take with a noun, with a pronoun and with the Yaa' ul Mutakallim?
13. Write all four differences between the Lam ul Jarrah and the Lam ul Ta'reef.
14. Separate both Murakkabat Naqisah in the hadith مَنْ خَرَجَ فِي ظَلَبِ الْعِلْمِ.
15. Give a full analysis of عَنْ أَبِي هُرَيْرَةَ, and state why هُرَيْرَةَ carries a fathah.
16. Write the rule of Ijtima' as-Sakinayn and state its exception.
17. Write the rule concerning standing vowels and give two examples each from إِلَى and عَلَى.
18. What may stand in the place of the majroor in a Murakkab Jarri? Give one example of each case.
19. Take out every Murakkab Jarri in Surah al-Qadr and analyse each one.

سُبْحَانَكَ اللَّهُمَّ وَبِحَمْدِكَ، أَشْهَدُ أَنْ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا أَنْتَ، أَسْتَغْفِرُكَ وَأَتُوبُ إِلَيْكَ

اللَّهُمَّ صَلِّ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا صَلَّيْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ

اللَّهُمَّ بَارِكْ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا بَارَكْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ